

Case Study #2

SAP Customer Service Process Transition & Improvement

1. Business Context

The company currently manages customer service requests through a customer portal connected to Salesforce.

Customers submit service requests through the portal. These requests are received in the Salesforce-based customer service environment, where Customer Service agents review customer information, classify and prioritize requests, coordinate required activities, communicate with customers, and resolve or close cases.

The company is planning to transition from the existing Salesforce-based customer service landscape toward an integrated SAP customer service environment.

The future landscape will use **SAP Service Cloud** as the main customer service and case-management layer, integrated with **SAP S/4HANA** for relevant ERP and backend business processes.

SAP Service Cloud will support activities such as:

- Case or service-request creation
- Classification and categorization
- Prioritization
- Routing and assignment
- Agent processing
- Customer communication
- Case status and resolution management

SAP S/4HANA will support relevant backend business information and processes, such as:

- Customer and business-partner information
- Product and equipment information
- Service-related business processes
- Orders
- Billing and other ERP-related processes

The existing customer service process is operational. Therefore, the objective of the project is not simply to fix a broken process.

Instead, the system transition provides an opportunity to review the existing end-to-end customer service process, identify gaps and improvement opportunities, standardize process steps, reduce unnecessary handoffs, and define an improved future-state process supported by the SAP landscape.

2. Field Service Scenario

Not every customer service request requires physical work at the customer's location.

If a customer request can be resolved by the Customer Service team, the case continues through the normal service process without involving field service.

Examples include:

- Billing questions

- Product-information requests
- Account-related questions
- General complaints
- Service-status inquiries

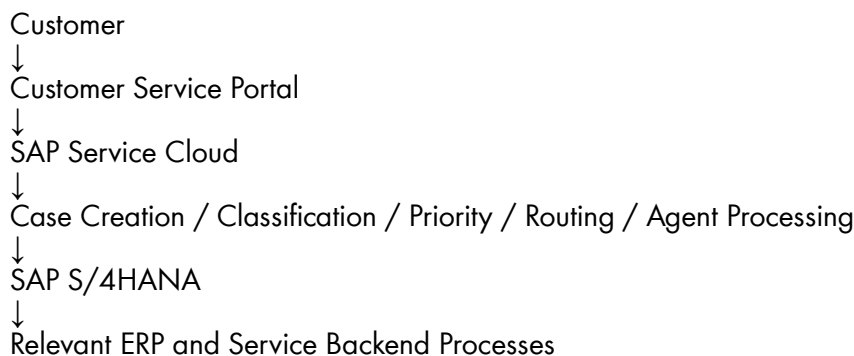
However, **when an on-site visit is required**, the process can involve SAP Field Service Management / SAP Field Service and Asset Management.

For example, if a customer reports an equipment failure that cannot be resolved remotely, the service process can trigger field-service activities such as:

- Technician planning
- Technician assignment
- Scheduling
- Dispatch
- On-site service execution
- Service completion
- Feedback of the completed work into the service process

After the field-service activity is completed, the relevant status or service result is returned to the customer-service process so that the original case can be resolved and closed.

3. Simplified Future-State Architecture



Conditional branch:

Does the request require an on-site technician?

No → Continue normal customer-service process → Resolve case → Close case

Yes → Field Service Management → Technician Planning → Scheduling / Dispatch → On-Site Work → Service Completion → Update Service Case → Resolve Case → Close Case

4. Business Objective

The objective of this case study is to design a standardized and improved customer service process for the transition from a Salesforce-based service environment toward an integrated SAP customer service landscape.

The project will focus on:

- Understanding the existing customer service process
- Identifying stakeholders and responsibilities
- Mapping the AS-IS process

- Identifying process and system gaps
- Identifying improvement opportunities
- Designing the TO-BE SAP customer service process
- Defining when field service is required
- Translating business needs into requirements
- Managing change activities through Jira
- Defining acceptance criteria
- Preparing UAT test cases
- Supporting release and implementation
- Preparing user communication
- Reviewing the process after go-live

5. Project Scope

IN SCOPE

- Customer service request submission
- Case/service-request creation
- Customer identification
- Case categorization
- Priority determination
- Case routing and assignment
- Customer Service agent processing
- Internal coordination
- Customer communication
- Case resolution and closure
- SAP Service Cloud interaction
- Relevant SAP S/4HANA backend integration
- Conditional field-service process
- Technician planning and dispatch where required
- Process standardization
- Process improvement
- Business requirements
- Functional requirements
- Jira change management
- Acceptance criteria
- UAT
- Release and implementation planning
- User communication

- Post-go-live support

OUT OF SCOPE

- ABAP programming
- Detailed SAP technical configuration
- SAP infrastructure setup
- Detailed API development
- Detailed Salesforce development
- Actual data migration execution
- Detailed financial accounting configuration
- Procurement processes
- Technical mobile-app development

6. Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholder	Role in Process	Interest / Need	Involvement
Customer	Submits service requests and receives resolution	Simple request submission, transparency and fast resolution	Provides service request and receives updates
Customer Service Agent	Processes customer cases	Clear case information, easy classification, correct routing and access to required information	Main user of SAP Service Cloud
Customer Service Manager	Responsible for service operations	Standardized process, workload visibility, service quality and KPIs	Reviews requirements and approves process improvements
Application Process Manager	Coordinates business process and application changes	Stable and standardized end-to-end process	Analyzes process, coordinates requirements, testing and changes
SAP Service Cloud Team	Supports/configures service application	Clear functional requirements	Evaluates and implements Service Cloud changes
SAP S/4HANA Team	Supports backend SAP processes	Correct integration and business data	Supports S/4HANA-related requirements and integration
Field Service Team	Handles cases requiring physical service	Complete service information and clear work requirements	Performs on-site service when required
SAP/Integration Team	Supports communication between systems	Reliable data exchange between applications	Designs/supports system integrations
Key Users	Represent operational business users	Usable process that supports daily work	Validate requirements and participate in UAT
Release/Change Management	Coordinates production changes	Controlled and documented releases	Coordinates deployment and communication

Key Stakeholders

The primary stakeholders for the process transition are:

1. Customer Service Manager
2. Customer Service Agents / Key Users
3. Application Process Manager
4. SAP Service Cloud Team
5. SAP S/4HANA Team

Supporting stakeholders include the Field Service Team, Integration Team and Release/Change Management.

Mini Exercise – Field Service Decision

As an Application Process Manager, I would first analyze what information is required to determine whether a customer case can be resolved remotely or requires an on-site service visit.

The customer service process should capture sufficient information such as the customer and equipment details, problem description, error or notification information, and other relevant technical details. The Customer Service team can then perform an initial investigation or remote diagnosis where possible.

If the issue can be resolved remotely, the Customer Service team continues with the resolution. If the investigation determines that physical inspection, repair, replacement, or another on-site activity is required, the case should trigger the Field Service process.

The Field Service team should receive the relevant case, customer, equipment, technical and, where applicable, material-related information required to plan and execute the service activity. The dispatcher or planner can then coordinate technician assignment and scheduling.